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DIPLOMACY / MIDDLE EAST

Pakistan joins Tehran talks as regional tensions intensify

Iran meets Saudi, Turkish and Pakistani representatives to explore de-escalation, while conflict in Yemen tests regional security channels.

On Monday, 26 October, representatives from Pakistan, Saudi Arabia and Türkiye met Iranian leaders in Tehran to discuss de-escalation. Reuters reported that President Masoud Pezeshkian and Foreign Minister Abbas Araqchi attended. Iranian state media said consultations would continue.

Saudi Arabia sought negotiating channels to avert fighting. Pakistani officials said the talks addressed regional security, US–Iran dialogue, Houthi attacks, Strait of Hormuz traffic and Iranian port restrictions.

No settlement was announced. Differences over sanctions, shipping and enrichment continued despite the four-country diplomatic contacts.

BACKGROUND Earlier regional mediation produced a temporary understanding, but fighting resumed and disrupted Gulf shipping and energy security.

ANALYSIS Pakistan has strong interests in reducing shipping risks and fuel-price pressure. Diplomatic progress depends on concrete commitments and follow-up negotiations.

REVISION / THREE FACTS

01 Tehran hosted Pakistani, Saudi and Turkish representatives on 26 October.

02 Iranian state media reported that the four sides would continue talks.

03 Strait of Hormuz security and US–Iran relations remained central points of disagreement.

CSS ANGLE Current Affairs / International Relations — mediation, regional security and energy chokepoints.

SOURCE LINKS [1] · [34]

AT A GLANCE

POLICY RATE

State Bank raises its key rate to 12 percent to counter inflation pressures.

PARLIAMENT

Senate declines to introduce a bill restricting diplomatic passports.

ENERGY

Energas and Port Qasim Authority dispute the future of a proposed LNG terminal.

REGIONAL SECURITY

Egypt approves conditional defensive support for Saudi Arabia.

BIODIVERSITY

Yerevan summit launches a call to redirect incentives harmful to nature.

01 Pakistan

SBP POLICY RATE 12.00%
Decision 26 Oct 2026 · Radio Pakistan / SBP

KSE-100 CLOSE 163,038.47
26 Oct 2026 · APP / PSX market summary

ECONOMY / MONETARY POLICY

State Bank lifts policy rate to 12 percent

A 50-basis-point increase seeks to contain inflation expectations as elevated energy costs strain the outlook.

On Monday, 26 October, the Monetary Policy Committee of the State Bank of Pakistan increased the policy rate by 50 basis points to 12 percent. The decision was supported by nine of the committee's ten members, according to the bank's statement reported by Dawn. Governor Jameel Ahmed announced the decision in Karachi.

The committee identified the Middle East conflict and sustained global energy prices as major risks to price stability. It assessed that the inflation outlook had deteriorated and argued that tighter monetary conditions were necessary to restrain further price increases. The committee restated an inflation target range of 5–7 percent and assessed that medium-term expectations would need firm policy support.

Dawn reported that September consumer inflation had eased to 10.3 percent from 11 percent in August, but the committee considered the outlook vulnerable to fuel prices and domestic food-supply pressures. It cited foreign-exchange reserves of around $21 billion and projected FY2027 real growth of 3.5–4.5 percent. The rate change may ease inflation pressure over time but also raises borrowing costs for households and firms.

BACKGROUND

The previous policy rate was 11.5 percent. Central banks adjust rates to affect credit conditions, demand and inflation; monetary policy cannot itself restore interrupted energy supplies.

ANALYSIS

The decision presents a difficult trade-off between lowering inflation and supporting private investment. Its impact will depend on the persistence of energy shocks, exchange-rate stability and fiscal discipline.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. Policy rate rose 50 basis points to 12 percent.
2. Nine of ten MPC members supported the increase.
3. The bank cited an inflation objective of 5–7 percent.

CSS ANGLE Economy / Current Affairs — monetary transmission and imported inflation.

SOURCE LINKS [2] · [3]

GOVERNANCE / PARLIAMENT

Senate rejects bill narrowing diplomatic passport entitlement

The proposed Passports Act amendment failed at introduction; other private members' legislation advanced in the upper house.

On Monday, 26 October, Pakistan's Senate rejected a motion to introduce the Passports (Amendment) Bill, 2026, which sought to restrict automatic diplomatic-passport entitlement for categories of public officeholders. PTI Senator Faisal Saleem

The sitting also considered consumer protection and plastic book-cover legislation. Dawn reported passage of a Consumer Protection (Amendment) Bill after a contested vote and approval of an amendment to Islamabad Capital Territory

Rehman and two co-sponsors put forward the measure; Minister of State for Interior Tallal Chaudhry opposed it.

The proposal would have added a new Section 12A to the Passports Act, 1974. Its scope included ministers of state, advisers, special assistants and specified senior officials; the proposal made exceptions for entitlements based on separate lawful diplomatic assignments or appointments. Its defeat meant the proposed restriction did not become law.

legislation addressing exemptions in the ban on plastic book covers. The PPP staged a walkout after an exchange between parliamentarians from coalition parties.

BACKGROUND Private members may propose legislation, but introduction and passage require the parliamentary steps prescribed by the house. Rejection of a motion to introduce a bill is not repeal of the underlying statute.

ANALYSIS The sitting illustrates the difference between an administrative privilege, a proposed statutory restriction and enacted law. It also highlights the room for coalition partners to diverge over individual bills.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. The Senate rejected introduction of the Passports (Amendment) Bill, 2026.
2. The rejected proposal would have inserted Section 12A in the 1974 Act.
3. The house approved separate consumer and plastic book-cover amendments.

CSS ANGLE Pakistan Affairs / Political Science — legislative procedure, accountability and coalition behaviour.

SOURCE LINKS [4]

FOREIGN POLICY / CHINA

Pakistan and China deepen foreign-ministry coordination

The third spokespersons' dialogue focuses on public diplomacy, media engagement and strategic communication.

On Monday, 26 October, Pakistan and China held the third round of their foreign-ministry spokespersons' dialogue in Islamabad, according to Pakistan's Foreign Office and Radio Pakistan. The meeting was led by Pakistan's spokesperson Sajjad Haider Khan and Chinese spokesperson Mao Ning.

Both delegations discussed closer working relations between their foreign ministries, including coordination in media engagement, strategic communication and public diplomacy. The official account stressed regular consultations and mutual understanding rather than announcing a new financial agreement.

Mao Ning also met Deputy Prime Minister and Foreign Minister Ishaq Dar. A Press Information Department statement said she conveyed greetings from Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi, while Dar reaffirmed the bilateral strategic partnership. The official record identifies diplomacy and communication as the immediate products of the meetings.

BACKGROUND

Pakistan and China maintain longstanding official consultations. Public diplomacy means communicating policy positions to foreign publics, while government spokesperson channels help explain official decisions and reduce misunderstandings.

ANALYSIS

Regular messaging channels can be important during rapidly evolving regional crises. Their practical value lies in ensuring consistency between public statements, working-level exchanges and wider diplomatic priorities.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. The third spokespersons' dialogue took place in Islamabad.
2. Sajjad Haider Khan and Mao Ning led the official meeting.
3. The agenda centred on communications and public diplomacy.

CSS ANGLE International Relations / Pakistan Affairs — China relations and diplomatic institutions.

SOURCE LINKS [5] · [6] · [7]

ENERGY / INVESTMENT

Port Qasim LNG terminal plan faces withdrawal dispute

Energas cites changed energy conditions as the port authority warns of a deadline and potential forfeiture.

On Monday, 26 October, Dawn reported that Energas, a Lucky Group–Qatar Energy consortium, had withdrawn from a proposed liquefied natural gas terminal at Port Qasim after citing changed policy conditions and unresolved fiscal and regulatory questions. The development concerned an infrastructure plan rather than an existing terminal closure.

The Port Qasim Authority had asked the consortium for unconditional acceptance and an updated project status by 30 November 2026. According to the reported communication, the authority warned that failure to respond could lead to termination of the final letter of intent and forfeiture of an initial $2 million concession fee. Energas sought return of that fee, disputing responsibility for the project's failure to progress.

The disagreement involved how privately developed terminal capacity might be used, regulated and integrated into Pakistan's gas market. Different parties disputed the effect of policy conditions. No court ruling or final resolution of the concession disagreement was reported on 26 October.

BACKGROUND

Liquefied natural gas is transported by specialised ships and regasified at import terminals before entry into domestic gas networks. Pakistan's investment plans depend partly on credible rules for access, tariffs and project finance.

ANALYSIS

The dispute signals how changes in energy demand and rules can affect projects with long lead times. A durable solution would require clarity about contractual commitments, market access and the balance of risks between the public authority and investors.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. Energas comprised Lucky Group and Qatar Energy interests.
2. The site under discussion was Port Qasim.
3. PQA set a 30 November deadline and cited a $2 million fee.

CSS ANGLE Economy / Pakistan Affairs — LNG policy, investor confidence and public contracts.

SOURCE LINKS [8]

PAKISTAN–US / ENERGY

Pakistan invites American financing for refinery upgrades

The petroleum minister and US chargé d'affaires discuss supply security and potential private investment.

On Monday, 26 October, Petroleum Minister Ali Pervaiz Malik met US Chargé d'Affaires Natalie Baker in Islamabad and invited American financial institutions to consider refinery-upgrade projects in Pakistan. Radio Pakistan reported that both sides discussed energy security against the backdrop of disruption in the wider Middle East.

The minister said Pakistani and American teams were examining avenues for energy cooperation. He also drew attention to investment possibilities in the minerals sector. Dawn reported that officials from Pakistan State Oil and Pakistan LNG Limited briefed participants about commercial interest in

The meeting was exploratory: the reporting identified proposed cooperation and investment interest, not a signed financing agreement or guaranteed investment amount. Pakistan has an economic interest in modernising refining capacity while protecting the reliability and affordability of oil and gas supplies.

BACKGROUND Upgrading refineries may improve the quality of refined products and domestic supply capability, but implementation depends on regulation, investment agreements, equipment and commercially viable terms.

ANALYSIS Potential American participation could

LNG supply from US companies.

diversify financing and suppliers. Any concrete result must ultimately be evaluated against import costs, environmental standards and the terms of procurement or investment agreements.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. Ali Pervaiz Malik met Natalie Baker in Islamabad.
2. Refinery upgrades and minerals were raised as investment opportunities.
3. No final US financing agreement was reported.

CSS ANGLE Current Affairs / Economy — energy security, foreign investment and bilateral trade.

SOURCE LINKS [9] · [10]

ECONOMY / FUEL PRICES

Government raises petrol and diesel prices for 27 October

The decision announced on Monday adjusts the ex-depot cost of two important transport fuels.

On Monday, 26 October, the federal government announced increases of Rs1.54 per litre for petrol and Rs2.16 per litre for high-speed diesel, according to Dawn's account of the Petroleum Division notification. The revised prices took effect on Tuesday, 27 October.

Under the announcement, petrol was set at Rs379.25 per litre and diesel at Rs395.82 per litre. Dawn reported that taxes and duties included Rs114 per litre on petrol and Rs100 per litre on diesel. These are price and tax figures for the announced revision, not estimates of downstream consumer inflation.

Petrol and diesel are important cost components for commuting, goods transport and production. Their direct retail effect is immediate once the revised schedule applies, while wider changes in food distribution and business costs vary by sector and competition. Policymakers also face pressure to manage fuel supply amid the regional conflict.

BACKGROUND

Domestic pump prices reflect international product costs, exchange rates, taxes and the prevailing pricing mechanism. Separate components may move in different directions even when the final retail price changes by a small amount.

ANALYSIS

Fuel-price changes can raise inflation expectations and affect household purchasing power. Their importance is magnified when monetary policy is already tightening to counter imported inflation.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. Petrol was raised by Rs1.54 to Rs379.25 per litre.
2. Diesel was raised by Rs2.16 to Rs395.82 per litre.
3. The announced rates became effective on 27 October.

CSS ANGLE Economy / Pakistan Affairs — administered prices and inflation transmission.

SOURCE LINKS [11] · [35]

02 World

WEST ASIA / SECURITY

Egypt approves defensive assistance to Saudi Arabia

Parliament grants conditional authority but no announced troop deployment follows the closed session.

On Monday, 26 October, Egypt's parliament authorised President Abdel Fattah al-Sisi to take measures supporting Saudi Arabia's defence against attacks by Yemen's Houthi movement, Reuters reported. At least two-thirds of lawmakers endorsed the resolution in a closed session, according to a parliamentary statement.

The president had described any Egyptian role as defensive and directed towards Saudi territory and borders, not strikes inside Yemen. No formal Saudi request for Egyptian troops had been made public when Reuters reported the decision. Several Egyptian opposition groups questioned military involvement or called for diplomatic engagement.

The vote took place as Saudi Arabia confronted increased pressure on energy infrastructure and shipping approaches. Egypt has a direct strategic interest in Red Sea passage and the Suez Canal, but the parliamentary authorisation did not establish the size, timing or precise nature of any deployment.

BACKGROUND

Egypt participated mainly through naval support in the Saudi-led intervention that began in 2015. The Bab el-Mandeb Strait links the Red Sea to the Gulf of Aden and is relevant to trade approaching the Suez Canal.

ANALYSIS

The parliamentary move created a legal and political option for defensive support. It also exposed the difficult balance between alliance obligations, domestic consent and the risks of wider involvement.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. The Egyptian parliament voted on 26 October.
2. At least two-thirds supported the measure, Reuters reported.
3. The stated purpose was defence of Saudi territory if requested.

CSS ANGLE International Relations — regional alliances, defence authorisation and maritime chokepoints.

SOURCE LINKS [12] · [37]

YEMEN / CONFLICT

Houthi movement claims strikes on Saudi energy infrastructure

Claims of attacks and Saudi counteroperations add pressure to oil transport and humanitarian access.

On Monday, 26 October, Yemen's Houthi movement said it had attacked pumping stations on Saudi Arabia's East–West crude-oil pipeline and Riyadh's airport, Reuters reported. Saudi authorities did not immediately confirm the specific Houthi claims. The absence of confirmation makes attribution and damage assessments provisional.

The Saudi-led coalition separately reported destroying two ballistic-missile launchers in Sanaa, including one it linked to a missile it said had been intercepted. Coalition officials also reported strikes against tunnels, launch equipment and supply

The developments drew attention to the East–West pipeline, a route that has become more important while shipping through the Strait of Hormuz has been restricted. Increased fighting also threatens humanitarian access inside Yemen and security around the Bab el-Mandeb approach to the Red Sea.

BACKGROUND The Yemen conflict has involved Houthi forces and a Saudi-led coalition since the mid-2010s. A United Nations-mediated truce beginning in 2022 had reduced fighting, but more recent escalation undermined it.

facilities. These were statements from one party to the conflict and were not presented as independent casualty or damage assessments.

ANALYSIS Even unconfirmed strike claims can raise shipping and insurance concerns. Accurate security reporting must distinguish between what each party claims, what is independently documented and what remains unknown.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. Houthis claimed attacks on the East–West pipeline and Riyadh airport.
2. Reuters noted no immediate Saudi confirmation of those claims.
3. The coalition separately reported launchers destroyed in Sanaa.

CSS ANGLE Current Affairs / International Relations — proxy conflict, energy routes and verification.

SOURCE LINKS [13] · [1]

GLOBAL MARKETS / GULF

Gulf shares rise amid hopes for Iran talks

Saudi and Qatari benchmarks strengthen while Egyptian equities decline ahead of a defence vote.

On Monday, 26 October, Gulf stock markets largely closed higher as investors assessed the prospect of talks between Iran and representatives of Saudi Arabia, Pakistan and Türkiye. Reuters reported a 3.4 percent rise in Saudi Arabia's benchmark index and a 2.8 percent increase in Qatar's index.

The Saudi gain was the market's strongest one-day rise in more than 13 months, according to Reuters. The shares of Saudi Arabian Mining Company rose 7.3 percent and Saudi Aramco gained 1.7 percent. Dubai and Abu Dhabi indexes increased 0.3 and 0.6 percent respectively. Egypt's main index, by contrast, declined 1.7 percent ahead of the parliamentary defence decision.

These movements reflected prices in one trading session, not confirmed improvements in physical oil supply or a diplomatic agreement. Regional risk perceptions can alter quickly when attacks, sanctions, shipping disruptions or official statements change.

BACKGROUND

Equity indexes summarise price movements in selected traded firms. An index rise does not mean every company gained, and daily percentage changes cannot by themselves establish an enduring economic trend.

ANALYSIS

A positive market response to diplomacy shows that investors were sensitive to prospects for de-escalation. The causal link between a meeting and durable economic recovery remains uncertain.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. Saudi benchmark increased 3.4 percent.
2. Qatar benchmark increased 2.8 percent.
3. Egypt's main index declined 1.7 percent.

CSS ANGLE Economy / International Relations — geopolitical risk and financial-market indicators.

SOURCE LINKS [14] · [36]

HUMAN RIGHTS / WEST BANK

UN warns Hebron operation risks collective punishment

UN officials demand protection and return of displaced residents as Israel continues a security operation.

On Monday, 26 October, UN human-rights chief Volker Türk raised serious concern over Israeli military measures in Hebron in the occupied West Bank, according to AFP reporting carried by Dawn.

BACKGROUND

The West Bank is territory occupied by Israel since 1967. International

Hebron municipal authorities said 3,189 people had been forced from their homes during the operation.

The Israeli operation followed a deadly attack on a checkpoint in which two soldiers were killed by Palestinian gunmen, who were later killed in a gunfight. Israeli forces subsequently entered a Hebron neighbourhood and ordered residents to leave. The UN human-rights chief criticised forced displacement, property destruction and restrictions on movement, and called for affected residents to be allowed to return.

UN Secretary-General António Guterres, speaking in Cairo, also expressed alarm about evictions and settlement-related violence in the West Bank. The UN's concerns are legal and humanitarian assessments; precise displacement figures were attributed to the municipal authority rather than presented as independently audited numbers.

humanitarian law governs the conduct of occupying powers and protects civilians, including against collective penalties.

ANALYSIS

The report shows how a security response following a violent attack may raise questions of proportionality and civilian protection. Diplomatic debate will depend on evidence about orders, displacement and access for affected families.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. UN human-rights chief Volker Türk raised concerns on 26 October.
2. Hebron municipal officials reported 3,189 displaced residents.
3. The UN called for return and redress for unlawful displacement.

CSS ANGLE International Relations / Current Affairs — occupation, international law and civilian protection.

SOURCE LINKS [15] · [38]

ENVIRONMENT / COP17

Countries launch new drive to reform harmful nature subsidies

A Yerevan initiative seeks to redirect financial incentives that damage ecosystems toward conservation.

On Monday, 26 October, the COP17 presidency announced the Yerevan Call on Incentives Positive to Biodiversity at the United Nations biodiversity conference in Armenia. A UNDP Biodiversity Finance Initiative release said Armenia was leading the proposal with support from the Convention on Biological Diversity Secretariat and partner institutions.

The programme is designed to help governments review spending and incentives that contribute to biodiversity loss and move resources towards conservation. Reuters separately reported that Colombia and Finland, supported by France, would lead efforts linked to redirecting $500 billion annually in subsidies identified as harmful to biodiversity. The Reuters figure describes an international target, not finance already redirected.

The UNDP release connected the initiative to Target 18 of the global biodiversity framework, which concerns reform of harmful incentives. The proposed mechanisms require implementation decisions by individual governments. Announcing a programme and measuring its actual environmental effects are two different stages.

BACKGROUND Biodiversity refers to variation among living organisms, including within species, between species and across ecosystems. Public spending may unintentionally encourage practices that reduce habitat or damage soil and water.

ANALYSIS Public finance reform can complement protected areas and conservation laws by changing the economic incentives behind land and resource use. The real test is whether countries identify harmful support, redirect funds and measure outcomes.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. The Yerevan Call was announced at COP17 on 26 October.
2. The plan addresses biodiversity-harming incentives under Target 18.

3. Reuters reported a $500 billion annual redirection objective.

CSS ANGLE Environmental Science / Economy — biodiversity finance and subsidy reform.

SOURCE LINKS [16] · [17]

Next Seven Days

27 October 2026 | Israel's parliamentary election is scheduled. [28]

27–29 October 2026 | WHO Malaria Policy Advisory Group holds its 30th virtual meeting. [25]

27–29 October 2026 | WHO International Working Group for Drug Statistics Methodology meets. [26]

28 October 2026 | WHO Madrid Global Obesity Summit reaches its scheduled closing date. [30]

3 November 2026 | United States congressional midterm elections are scheduled. [29]

03 General Knowledge

TWENTY FACTS / INSTITUTIONS, DATES AND MEASURES

01 DIPLOMACY Senior officials from Saudi Arabia, Türkiye and Pakistan met Iranian leaders in Tehran on 26 October. [1]

02 SECURITY The Mecca mutual-defence arrangement connects Saudi Arabia, Pakistan and Türkiye, according to Reuters. [1]

03 MONETARY The State Bank's 26 October policy-rate decision set the rate at 12 percent. [2]

04 MONETARY The 26 October rate change was an increase of 50 basis points. [3]

05 MONETARY Nine of ten MPC members supported the 26 October increase. [2]

06 ECONOMY The MPC cited a medium-term inflation target range of 5–7 percent. [2]

07 FINANCE The KSE-100 finished 26 October at 163,038.47 points, APP reported. [18]

08 FINANCE Mettis Global reported a USD/PKR interbank close of Rs276.82 for 26 October. [19]

09 PARLIAMENT The proposed Passports (Amendment) Bill, 2026, failed at introduction in the Senate. [4]

10 GOVERNANCE The rejected passport proposal would have inserted a new Section 12A. [4]

11 CHINA Pakistan and China held their third foreign-ministry spokespersons' dialogue in Islamabad. [7]

12 ENERGY The Port Qasim Authority warned of a 30 November 2026 response deadline for Energas. [8]

13 ENERGY The initial Port Qasim concession fee cited in the report was $2 million. [8]

14 FUEL The government announced petrol at Rs379.25 per litre effective 27 October. [11]

15 FUEL The government announced high-speed diesel at Rs395.82 per litre effective 27 October. [11]

16 EGYPT Egypt's parliament authorised conditional defensive support for Saudi Arabia on 26 October. [12]

17 MARKETS Saudi Arabia's benchmark equity index gained 3.4 percent on 26 October. [14]

18 RIGHTS Hebron municipal authorities reported 3,189 people displaced during the Israeli operation. [15]

19 BIODIVERSITY The COP17 Yerevan Call was linked to Global Biodiversity Framework Target 18. [16]

20 BIODIVERSITY Reuters reported a proposed redirection of $500 billion annually in harmful subsidies. [17]

04 Five Terms

Federalism

CONSTITUTIONAL AND POLITICAL SCIENCE

Federalism divides public authority between an overarching government and territorially defined governments. Both levels possess legally defined responsibilities and a degree of autonomy.

WHY IT MATTERS It explains the distribution of legislative authority and the design of intergovernmental relations.

EXAMPLE The United States Constitution and its Tenth Amendment reserve certain powers for states; the Tenth Amendment was ratified on 15 December 1791.

SOURCE LINKS [32]

Non-alignment

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND DIPLOMACY

Non-alignment is a foreign-policy orientation that seeks independent positions rather than automatic alignment with rival great-power blocs. It emerged as an organised movement during decolonisation and the Cold War.

WHY IT MATTERS It helps evaluate strategic autonomy, sovereignty and policy choices of developing states.

EXAMPLE The Non-Aligned Movement held its founding summit in Belgrade on 1–6 September 1961.

SOURCE LINKS [21]

Automatic fiscal stabilisers

ECONOMY AND PUBLIC FINANCE

Automatic stabilisers are tax and spending provisions that respond to economic fluctuations without a new legislative decision each time. Falling taxable incomes reduce revenue and some benefit payments may rise during a downturn.

WHY IT MATTERS They explain how budgets can moderate cycles even before discretionary stimulus is adopted.

EXAMPLE An IMF account published on 21 January 2009 described unemployment benefits and tax receipts adjusting automatically as economies contracted.

SOURCE LINKS [33]

Ombudsman

LAW, GOVERNANCE AND PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION

An ombudsman or ombuds office is a neutral mechanism through which concerns or grievances may be addressed outside adversarial proceedings. Its authority differs by statute, but the central purpose is fair handling of complaints and maladministration.

WHY IT MATTERS It illustrates administrative accountability and accessible grievance redress.

EXAMPLE Pakistan’s federal Wafaqi Mohtasib was established by Presidential Order in 1983.

SOURCE LINKS [27]

Ocean acidification

ENVIRONMENT AND SCIENCE

Ocean acidification is the decline in seawater pH caused mainly by absorption of atmospheric carbon dioxide. Dissolved carbon dioxide alters seawater chemistry and can make shell-building more difficult for some marine organisms.

WHY IT MATTERS It connects climate science, marine food chains and the governance of ocean ecosystems.

EXAMPLE By 2008, losses at a large US Pacific Northwest oyster hatchery reached 80 percent; NOAA linked corrosive water to the larvae damage in 2010.

SOURCE LINKS [31]

05 Practice

15 MULTIPLE-CHOICE QUESTIONS

01. Which policy rate did the SBP announce on 26 October 2026?

A. 11.0 percent
B. 11.5 percent
C. 12.0 percent
D. 12.5 percent

02. Which capital hosted talks involving Iran, Pakistan, Saudi Arabia and Türkiye?

A. Tehran
B. Doha
C. Riyadh
D. Istanbul

03. Which institution rejected the introduction of the Passports (Amendment) Bill, 2026?

A. National Assembly
B. Federal Cabinet
C. Supreme Court
D. Senate

04. Who headed the Chinese side of the third spokespersons' dialogue?

A. Wang Yi
B. Mao Ning
C. Jiang Zaidong
D. Qin Gang

05. Which fuel was announced at Rs395.82 per litre for 27 October?

A. Motor petrol
B. Kerosene
C. High-speed diesel
D. Light diesel oil

06. Which port was the site of the proposed Energas LNG terminal?

A. Port Qasim
B. Gwadar Port
C. Karachi Port
D. Pasni Port

07. How many basis points did the SBP add to the policy rate?

A. 25 points
B. 75 points
C. 100 points
D. 50 points

08. Which country's parliament authorised defensive support for Saudi Arabia?

A. Jordan
B. Egypt
C. Oman
D. Kuwait

09. Which index gained 3.4 percent on 26 October?

A. Dubai benchmark
B. Egyptian blue-chip
C. Saudi benchmark
D. Qatar benchmark

10. Which UN biodiversity target relates to reforming harmful incentives?

A. Target 18
B. Target 5
C. Target 10
D. Target 2

11. How many people did Hebron municipal officials report displaced?

A. 2,189
B. 3,189
C. 4,189
D. 5,189

12. In the Port Qasim dispute, what date was specified by PQA for a response?

A. 15 November
B. 20 November
C. 25 November
D. 30 November

13. Which feature describes a federal system?

A. All authority in one ministry
B. No regional governments
C. Two legally empowered government levels
D. No constitutional division of authority

14. Which event marked the 1961 founding summit of non-alignment?

A. The Belgrade summit
B. The Bandung summit
C. The Havana summit
D. The Cairo summit

15. Which change best illustrates an automatic fiscal stabiliser?

A. Parliament approving a new dam
B. A new one-time tax amnesty
C. Government issuing foreign bonds
D. Unemployment benefits rising during recession

Answer Key

01 C The MPC raised the rate by 50 basis points to 12 percent. [2]

02 A The talks took place in Tehran on 26 October. [1]

03 D The Senate rejected the motion to introduce the measure. [4]

04 B Mao Ning represented the Chinese foreign-ministry spokespersons' side. [7]

05 C The announced high-speed diesel price was Rs395.82. [11]

06 A The consortium's project concerned Port Qasim. [8]

07 D The committee announced a 50-basis-point increase. [3]

08 B Egyptian parliament authorised the measures on 26 October. [12]

09 C Reuters reported a 3.4 percent gain in the Saudi benchmark. [14]

10 A The UNDP biodiversity release linked the Yerevan Call to Target 18. [16]

11 B AFP quoted the Hebron municipality's figure of 3,189. [15]

12 D Dawn reported a PQA deadline of 30 November 2026. [8]

13 C Federalism allocates law-making powers to national and territorial levels. [20]

14 A The NAM founding summit was held in Belgrade in September 1961. [21]

15 D Automatic changes in taxes and benefits respond to the business cycle. [22]

06 References

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